

TB Step Shifter

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Overview

Moves selected harmonics to create new pitch and tone without shifting the whole sound in the usual way.

What this plug-in solves

Conventional pitch shifting moves every spectral component together. TB Step Shifter tracks a pitched source, identifies its harmonic series, and relocates selected harmonics. This allows pitch movement or upper-harmonic recoloring while preserving more of the original timing and, in Colorize mode, the fundamental.

What you can expect

- Harmonic-series transposition
- Upper-harmonic recoloring with a grounded fundamental
- Fast or fine analysis resolution
- Continuous dry/wet and harmonic selection control

How it works

TB Step Shifter moves selected harmonic detail in discrete steps rather than shifting the complete signal as one block. This changes both pitch impression and tone, creating animated harmonies, synthetic edges, and game-like or mechanical movement while some of the original identity remains.

Pitch sets the broad direction, Step determines the size of each movement, and Resolution decides how finely the spectrum is divided. Colorize changes the resulting tone and Mix restores the dry source. Begin with a simple sustained sound so the step pattern is easy to hear before using it on complex material.

Quick start

- 1 Use a clean, clearly pitched monophonic source.
- 2 Choose Fast for moving lines or Fine for sustained tones.
- 3 Set Pitch.

- 4 Raise Step until enough harmonics move.
- 5 Enable Colorize for timbral rather than full-note shifting.
- 6 Set Mix in context.

Interface and key sections



This is a direct capture of the current plug-in interface. Use the visible labels to locate the areas and controls explained below.

Pitch

Sets how far and in which direction the selected harmonic structure is shifted.

Step

Controls how much of the harmonic structure participates in the relocation. Lower values affect fewer components; higher values transform more of the series.

Colorize

When off, the detected harmonic series is shifted as a pitch effect. When on, the fundamental can remain grounded while upper harmonics move, creating a new timbral identity.

Resolution

Fast responds more quickly and suits changing notes; Fine uses more detailed analysis and suits stable, sustained material.

Mix and Programs

Mix blends the reconstruction with the original. Programs cover clean octave, fifth, deep octave, sub weight, harmonic glass, and warm patina.

Controllable properties

The guide uses the names shown on the plug-in panel. Each explanation describes the audible result, a useful way to approach the control, and an important interaction to listen for.

Control	What it does and when to use it
Bypass	Turns the complete effect off or on for a direct before-and-after comparison. Compare with bypass at a similar loudness. If the effect creates a tail, let that tail settle before judging the difference.
Colorize	Adds a warmer, more colored character to the shifted harmonics. Sweep broadly to find the useful tonal area, then make the focus narrower and the change smaller while listening in the full mix.
Mix	Blends the original sound with the processed sound. Turn the processed sound up temporarily to learn its character, then return to the mix and keep only the amount that supports the source.
Pitch	Moves the pitch of the processed sound up or down. Choose the musical direction first, then check attacks and sustained notes for unwanted wobble or a change in character.
Program	Loads a factory starting point. Adjust the controls afterward to fit the current sound. Use a preset as a direction, not a finished answer. Change one section at a time so it is clear which adjustment improves the source.
Resolution	Chooses faster response or finer harmonic detail. Compare the available characters on the same short passage. Choose by the musical result rather than by the name of the mode.
Step	Chooses which part of the harmonic series is moved by the Pitch control. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.

Practical uses

Harmonic color

- Enable Colorize.
- Set Pitch to +7 or +12 semitones.
- Use medium Step and Fine resolution.
- Blend below full wet.

Expected result: The note center stays recognizable while overtones take on a glassy or shifted color.

Spectral octave

- Disable Colorize.
- Set Pitch to +12 or -12.
- Increase Step and choose the resolution that follows the performance.

Expected result: The tracked harmonic series moves toward a distinct octave transformation.

Common pitfalls

Polyphonic or noisy sources can confuse fundamental tracking. Return the strongest control toward neutral, compare with bypass at a similar loudness, and add the processing back one section at a time.

Very low fundamentals may not provide enough stable harmonics. Return the strongest control toward neutral, compare with bypass at a similar loudness, and add the processing back one section at a time.

The effect is intentionally different from transparent broadband pitch shifting. Feed the plug-in one clear note at a time, confirm the musical key or target, and reduce correction or variation if the result becomes unstable.